ARENA SCHOOL

ACAMIS TECHNOLOGY CONFERENCE · OCTOBER 18, 2026

A case study from the INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL OF BEIJING 北京顺义国际学校

From Lab *to Classroom*

Running an AI Student Program Inside a School

THE NEXT 60 MINUTES

From what students built in five days *to what you can run at your school.*

1

The case

15 minutes

2

Why it worked

10 minutes

3

Build one, live

30 minutes

4

Take it back

5 minutes

We trained at ISB, Caltech, Harvard, Brown, and Tsinghua, then did *the jobs AI is now automating.*



Jing Jing Yang

WAB AND ISB ALUM · ISB CLASS OF 2019

Worked in international growth at Kimi, a leading Chinese AI lab

STUDIED INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL OF BEIJING 北京顺义国际学校 · BROWN · 清華大學 Tsinghua University

WORKED · Deloitte. · CICC 中金公司 · KIMI



Phillip An

FORBES 30 UNDER 30

Co-founder and CEO of Skylarq AI
Co-founded Homebase, backed by Y Combinator

STUDIED Caltech · HARVARD · 清華大學 Tsinghua University

WORKED Goldman Sachs · McKinsey&Company · LinkedIn

THE QUESTION WE TRY TO ANSWER AT ARENA SCHOOL

When AI can do all of these in seconds, what must our students *still learn to do?*

WHERE THIS STARTED · OCTOBER 14, 2026

At ISB's PTA Parent Coffee, parents asked one question: *which skills will outlast the tools?*

WHAT PARENTS ASKED

Which skills last as the tools change?

Will AI do the thinking for my child?

What should my child practice now?

WHAT THIS SESSION SHOWS

Three skills that outlast any tool

Students doing the thinking

Real products, built in five days

PART 1

In five days, ISB students built and launched *working products with AI.*

The program, the week, and what students made

1 The case
What students built

2 Why it worked
The design

3 Build one, live
With the room

4 Take it back
What it takes

An AI builder week for grades 7 to 12: *learn AI skills, start a company, build something real.*



Mentors in the room every day



Every team demos what works

7–12 grades, selected by application

5 days, at ISB in August

0 coding experience required

Students don't study startups. *They run one, in ten stages, with the AI tools professionals use.*

01
Find the idea
A real problem, in one sentence



02
Validate it
Interview real people first



03
Form the team
Builder, designer, storyteller



04
Define it
The smallest useful version



05
Design it
Screens, type, and color



06
Build it
Direct AI tools to build it



07
Ship it live
A public link of its own



08
Test and iterate
Watch users, then rebuild



09
Brand it
A name, a logo, and a story



10
Pitch and sell
Set a price, pitch it live



Five days, from a one-page plan *to a live product on demo day.*

MORNINGS ARE LESSONS · AFTERNOONS ARE BUILD SESSIONS

DAY 1

Pick a problem

A one-page plan and a first prototype.

DAY 2

Go public

Real people try it. Teams fix what confuses them.

DAY 3

The rebuild

Strong projects rarely look like the day-one plan.

DAY 4

Polish and price

A name, a landing page, and a real price.

DAY 5

Demo day

Two-minute live pitches to judges and families.

Students learned more than 20 AI tools in five days, *out of 200+ they could choose from.*

RESEARCH

Ask and search

- ChatGPT
- Gemini
- NotebookLM
- Manus
- Mistral
- Claude
- Perplexity
- DeepSeek
- Grok

DESIGN

Logos and art

- Midjourney
- Ideogram
- Krea
- Recraft

BUILD

Apps and sites

- Cursor
- Lovable
- Replit
- v0
- Windsurf

BRAND

Sound and video

- Suno
- ElevenLabs
- CapCut

LAUNCH

Sell and promote

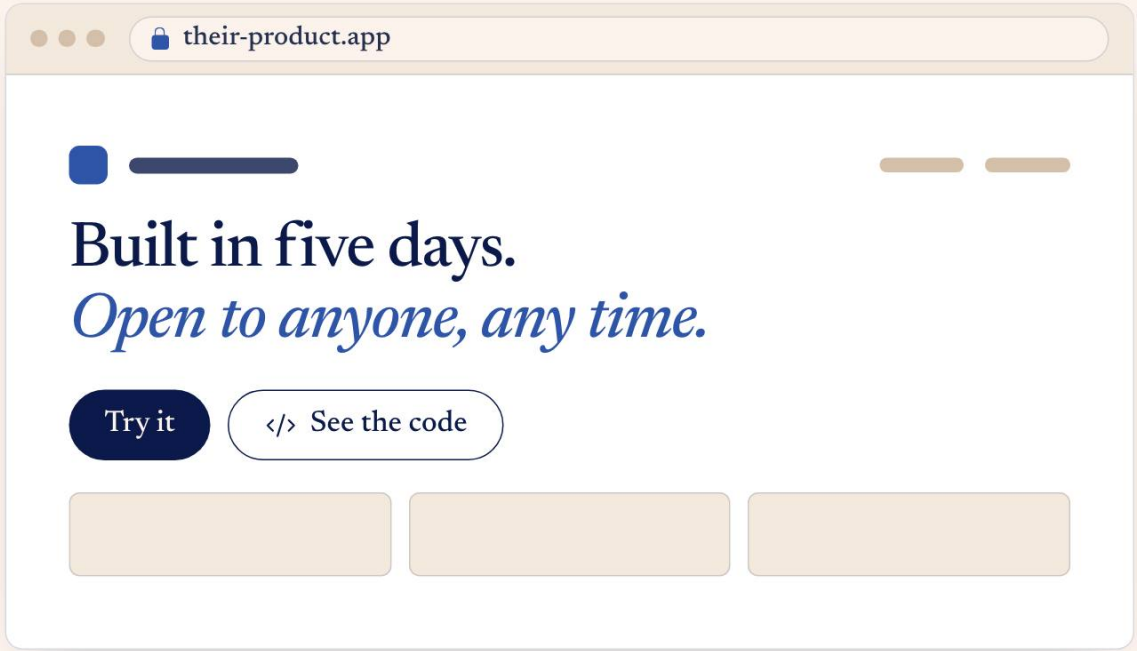
- Stripe
- Pika
- Runway

200+ AI TOOLS STUDENTS COULD CHOOSE FROM

ChatGPT Claude Gemini DeepSeek Doubao Qwen Yuanbao ERNIE Grok Copilot Meta AI Le Chat Perplexity Poe Character.AI Pi ChatGLM MiniMax Hunyuan Spark Baichuan StepFun Skywork Metaso Felo You.com Phind Consensus Elicit Scite NotebookLM Notion AI Gamma Tome Beautiful.ai Pitch Canva Figma Make Framer Webflow Lovable Bolt v0 Replit Cursor Windsurf GitHub Copilot TRAE Claude Code Codex Devin Tabnine Cody Zed Warp JetBrains AI Amazon Q Gemini CLI Qoder CodeBuddy Comate Kiro Midjourney DALL·E Ideogram Leonardo Firefly Stable Diffusion FLUX Krea Recraft Playground Lovart Dreamina Liblib Kolors Wanxiang Sora Veo Runway Pika Luma Kling Hailuo Vidu PixVerse Seedance HeyGen Synthesia D-ID CapCut Descript OpusClip Captions Hedra Higgsfield InVideo Flow Suno Udio ElevenLabs Murf Speechify Otter Fireflies Granola Whisper Krisp AIVA Comet Dia Atlas Flowith Coze Dify n8n Zapier Make Lindy Relevance AI Gumloop CrewAI LangChain AutoGPT Cue WorkBuddy Fellou AutoGLM Grammarly Jasper Copy.ai Writesonic Sudowrite QuillBot Wordtune DeepL Rytr Lex Mem Reflect Superhuman Motion Reclaim Clockwise Fathom tl;dv Read AI Tactiq Zoom AI Slack AI Miro AI Whimsical Napkin Glean Raycast Monica Sider MaxAI Merlin HARPA Khanmigo Duolingo Max Quizlet Photomath Brainly Gauth Question.AI Speak Praktika ELSA MagicSchool Brisk Diffit Curipod SchoolAI Squirrel AI Spline Meshy Tripo Uizard Stitch Visily Relume Hugging Face Supabase Firebase Studio AI Studio OpenRouter Ollama LM Studio Jan Julius Llama Gemma Adobe Express Designer Pictory Lumen5 Notta Plaud

THE CASE · WHAT EVERY STUDENT WALKED OUT WITH

Students left with real work, *and they own all of it.*



A live product *at its own link, with the code behind it*



A live pitch *to judges, families, and peers*

Full ownership
The code, the design, and the brand stay theirs.

THE CASE · DEMO DAY

On day five, teams pitched working products *to judges from Harvard, Stanford, Y Combinator, and AI labs.*



Judges test each product before scoring

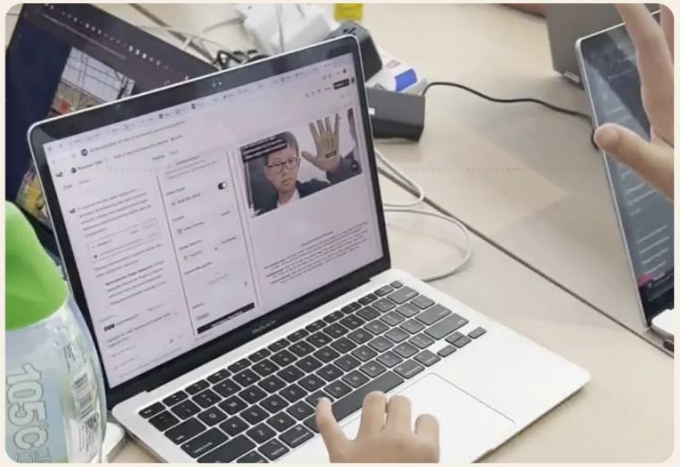


Every team pitched its own product

JUDGED BY FOUNDERS AND OPERATORS FROM HARVARD Stanford Y Combinator *and AI labs*

THE PILOT · BODLEY ACADEMY, HONG KONG, SUMMER 2025

In five days, an 11-year-old *turned sign language into speech.*



Built in five days by a seventh grader

01 **Agency**	FIND A PROBLEM	He chose sign language to speech because his cousin is deaf. Nobody assigned it.
02 **Taste**	REAL-USER FEEDBACK	He kept improving it after the demo, because his grandmother couldn't use the first version yet.
03 **Craft**	FINISH AND LAUNCH	The hardest part wasn't the AI. It was audio clear enough for her to trust.

AI tools did the building. *He did the choosing, judging, and finishing.*

20 students, each on their own problem

5 days, from the first idea to demo day

9.5/10 how likely students were to recommend it

PART 2

It worked because students made every decision, *and AI helped them build faster.*

Used well, AI deepens the thinking instead of replacing it.

THE RESEARCH · TWO 2025 STUDIES

Used as a shortcut, AI does the thinking.
Set up as a coach, it helps students learn more.

−17%

HIGH SCHOOL MATH · NEARLY 1,000 STUDENTS

exam grades after practicing with plain ChatGPT. A tutor version that gave hints, not answers, largely avoided the drop.

2×

HARVARD PHYSICS · A RANDOMIZED TRIAL

the learning gains of an active-learning class, in less time, with an AI tutor built on the same methods

Bastani and others, PNAS, June 25, 2025: grades fell 17% once plain ChatGPT was taken away; with safeguards, the harm was “largely mitigated”; Kestin and others, Scientific Reports, June 3, 2025: 194 Harvard physics students, median learning gains more than double

Agency chooses, taste judges, and craft finishes.

The week gave each one a moment students couldn't skip.

01 Agency

Deciding what is worth building, before anyone assigns it.

HOW THE WEEK TRAINED IT

On day one, each student chooses the problem and pitches it in three minutes, with no slides.

02 Taste

Judging whether the output is actually good, and saying why.

HOW THE WEEK TRAINED IT

By midweek, a prototype is online at a public link, and real users and mentors react every day.

03 Craft

Finishing it well enough that people can trust it.

HOW THE WEEK TRAINED IT

Building stops at a fixed hour each day, and on demo day students explain every decision live.

IS USING AI JUST CHEATING?

No. AI tools write the code, *and students make every decision.*

AI TOOLS AND MENTORS HANDLE

Writing the code

Putting it online

Fixing technical errors

STUDENTS DECIDE

Which problem, and for whom

What to cut after users try it

The name, the price, and the pitch

Your role becomes the coach, *and three questions do the coaching.*

THE TEACHER'S ROLE

From the person with the answers

↓

to the coach who asks the questions

It's what good teachers already do, and what our mentors did all week.

AGENCY

"Why this problem?"

They choose, not the AI.

TASTE

"How do you know it's good?"

They judge what it made.

CRAFT

"What would make someone trust it?"

They check it and finish it.

PART 3

Now we build one together. *No coding needed.*

Name a school chore. We build the fix together, live.

1 The case
What students built

2 Why it worked
The design

3 Build one, live
With the room

4 Take it back
What it takes

LIVE BUILD · 30 MINUTES

You bring a real school problem.
We build the fix together, live.

STEP 1 · YOU NAME IT

A chore or a snag

A workflow you repeat, or a problem you keep running into.

- *"I rewrite the same parent email every week."*
- *"Tracking which students turned in drafts."*
- *"Making one reading at three levels."*

→

STEP 2 · WE BUILD IT LIVE

Claude Code writes it

An AI tool that builds web apps from plain English.

Claude Code *by Anthropic*

```
› Make a page where I paste a reading and get it at three levels.
```

→ A working web app, in minutes

→

STEP 3 · WE ALL ITERATE

Open it, then improve it

We try it together and fix what's off, one plain sentence at a time.

- *"Make the buttons bigger."*
- *"Add a column for due dates."*
- *"Use simpler words for grade 6."*

LIVE BUILD · OPEN IT ON YOUR PHONE

What we just built is live. *Open it on your phone.*

OPEN WHAT WE BUILT

arenaschool.org/talks/2026-10-acamis-tech-workshop/build

WHAT IT TOOK

One room, 30 minutes, and plain English.

You named the problem. Claude Code wrote the code. Together we judged every version and decided when it was good enough.

WHAT IT SHOWS

The loop your students would practice: agency to pick the problem, taste to judge it, and craft to finish it.

More of what students built: arenaschool.org/results

PART 4

Take it back to your school: *what it takes to run this.*

TAKE IT BACK · PLANNING CHECKLIST

Your school already owns most of this.
Arena School can help with the rest.

YOUR SCHOOL OWNS

The learning goals and lasting skills

A five-day block on the calendar

Teachers, IT, and families on board

How students show their work

WHERE ARENA SCHOOL HELPS

Matching AI tools to each task

Prompting that builds thinking

Tools that work on your network

An idea to a product in five days

Checklist and China tool guide: arenaschool.org/talks/2026-10-acamis-tech-workshop

How we teach: arenaschool.org/approach

ARENA SCHOOL

Going further: we help schools bring AI *into teaching and learning.*

AI for Educators

Hands-on training at your school, with your teachers' own lessons

arenaschool.org/programs/teacher-training

Student programs

A five-day build week like ISB's, co-run with your teachers

arenaschool.org/programs/product-intensive

Curriculum design

Where AI fits in your courses, and how to assess it

arenaschool.org/contact

SELECTED WORK

arenaschool.org/results

INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL OF BEIJING 北京顺义国际学校

Student program · Beijing, 2026

Bodley Academy, Hong Kong

Student course · Hong Kong, 2025

SCHWARZMAN SCHOLARS

Staff training · Tsinghua University

IF YOU REMEMBER ONE THING

AI doesn't have to do the thinking for students.

The design is up to us.

1

Students can ship

Live products in five days,
with no coding background.

2

Design decides

Students choose,
judge, and finish.

3

Start small, start now

One project, one class,
and three questions.

You don't need to code. You already know how to coach.

When you're ready to run your own, Arena School can help. arenaschool.org

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Thank you! *We welcome your questions.*

SLIDES AND RESOURCES

arenaschool.org/talks/2026-10-acamis-tech-workshop

ARENA SCHOOL

BRING THIS TO YOUR SCHOOL

Book a 20-minute call

About teacher training, student programs, or curriculum design.

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BOOK A CALL

arenaschool.org/contact